

Esposito Lorenzo

Third-year PhD student in Psychology and Cognitive Sciences

✉ lorenzo.esposito@edu.unige.it

🆔 0009-0004-0483-0463

📄 Lorenzo Esposito

🔗 Lorentz31

EDUCATION

PhD in "Social Sciences XXXIX cycle" - Curriculum "Psychology and Cognitive Sciences"

University of Genova

📅 01/11/2023 – currently

Supervisor: Prof. David Giofrè

Master degree in "Cognitive Neuroscience and Clinical Neuropsychology"

University of Padova

📅 09/2019 – 07/2021

Final mark: 110 *cum laude*.

Thesis: *Representation of small vs large numerical quantities and the role of number notation: an electrophysiological study.*

Supervisor: Prof. Marco Zorzi

Bachelor degree in "Cognitive and Psychobiological Psychology"

University of Padova

📅 10/2016 – 07/2019

Final mark: 110 *cum laude*.

Thesis: *Discrimination of Simple Geometric Shapes in Zebrafish Larvae.*

Supervisor: Prof. Angelo Bisazza

WORK EXPERIENCE

PhD student

Disfor - University of Genova

📅 01/11/2023 - currently

📍 Corso Andrea Podestà 2, 16121, Genova

Supervisor: Prof. David Giofrè

PhD student - Visiting

University of Ulm (uulm)

📅 01/2026 - 08/2026

📍 Albert-Einstein-Allee 47, 89069 Ulm

Supervisor: Prof. Oliver Wilhelm

PhD student - Visiting

University of Amsterdam (UvA)

📅 07/2025 - 08/2025

📍 Nieuwe Achtergracht 129 B, 1018 VZ Amsterdam

Supervisor: Prof. Dylan Molenaar

Research assistant

Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization (DPSS) - University of Padova

📅 12/2022 - 10/2023

📍 Via Venezia 8, 35131, Padova

Post graduate intern

Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization (DPSS) - University of Padova

📅 12/2021 – 11/2022

📍 Via Venezia 8, 35131, Padova

Clinical center (Lab.D.A.)

📅 01/04/2022 – 30/11/2022

📍 Via Astichello 10, 35135, Padova

Pre graduate intern

Department of General Psychology (DPG) - University of Padova

📅 02/2021 – 05/2021

📍 Via Venezia 12, 35131, Padova

Pre graduate intern

Department of General Psychology (DPG) - University of Padova

📅 12/2018 – 02/2019

📍 Via Venezia 8, 35131, Padova

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed publications

1. **Esposito, L.** & Giofrè, D. (2026). Investigating the Impact of Attitudes and Learning Environment on Math Achievement: Insights from the TIMSS Data. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 264, 114046.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2026.114046>
2. **Esposito, L.**, Molenaar D. & Giofrè, D. (2026). Testing Cross-Group Comparability of INVALSI Scores Using Moderated Factor Analysis. *Intelligence* 118, 102042.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.intell.2026.102042>
3. Caviola, S., Giofrè, D., Toffalini, E., **Esposito L.**, Tonizzi, I. & Geary D. C. (2026). Sex Differences in Mathematics: A Meta-analytic Review Across Content, Grades, and Geographic Regions. *Educ Psychol Rev* 38, 58.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10648-026-10125-8>
4. **Esposito, L.**, Tonizzi, I., Usai M. C. & Giofrè, D. (2026). The Impact of Math Attitudes and Gender in Future School Choice: A Longitudinal Study Among Italian Students. *Journal of Intelligence*, 14(3), 38.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence14030038>
5. **Esposito, L.**, Toffalini, E., & Giofrè, D. (2026). Sex Differences in Mathematics and Reading Across Italy: The Role of Socioeconomic Factors. *Intelligence & Cognitive Abilities*, 2(1).
<https://doi.org/10.65550/001c.155775>
6. Ikeda, Y., **Esposito, L.**, Kita, Y., Oi, Y., Takagi, R., Suzuki, K., Mammarella, I. C., Caviola, S., Lanfranchi, S., Pulina, F., & Giofrè, D. (2026). Cognitive and Affective-Emotional Factors in Math Achievement: The Mediating Role of Intelligence. *Journal of Intelligence*, 14(2), 25.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence14020025>
7. **Esposito, L.**, Giofrè, D., Toffalini, E., & Geary, D. C. (2025). Sex differences in variability: Evidence from math and reading assessment in Italy. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 247, 113410.
<http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2025.113410>
8. **Esposito, L.**, Tonizzi, I., Usai, M. C., & Giofrè, D. (2025). Understanding the Role of Cognitive Abilities and Math Anxiety in Adolescent Math Achievement. *Journal of Intelligence*, 13(4), 44.
<http://dx.doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence13040044>

9. **Esposito, L.**, & Giofrè, D. (2025). Sex Differences in Intelligence on the WISC: A Meta-Analysis on Children with Specific Learning Disabilities. *Journal of Intelligence*, 13(2), 18.
<http://dx.doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence13020018>
10. Giofrè, D., Toffalini, E., Perugini, A., **Esposito, L.**, Amoretti, G., & Geary, D. C. (2024). Sex differences in cognition: A meta-analysis of variance ratios in the Wechsler Intelligence Scales for Children. *Personality and Individual Differences*, 229, 112776.
<http://dx.doi.org/10.1016/j.paid.2024.112776>
11. Giofrè, D., Toffalini, E., **Esposito, L.**, & Cornoldi, C. (2024). Sex/gender differences in general cognitive abilities: an investigation using the Leiter-3. *Cognitive Processing*, 25, 663–672.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s10339-024-01199-9>
12. Giofrè, D., Toffalini, E., **Esposito, L.**, & Cornoldi, C. (2023). Gender Differences in the Wechsler Intelligence Scale for Children in a Large Group of Italian Children with Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder. *Journal of Intelligence*, 11(9), 1-11.
<https://doi.org/10.3390/jintelligence11090178>

Manuscripts under revision

Coppola I., Rania N., **Esposito, L.**, Puzzo A. V., Giannoni P., Lagomarsino F. (2026) Validation of intercultural sensitivity scale in Italian professional contexts. *Manuscript under revision*

Tironi, M., **Esposito, L.**, Giofrè, D., Smiley, P. A., Kerr, M. L., Borelli, J. L. (2026) The Relational Savoring Questionnaire for Parents (RSQ-P): Development and validity among parents of young and school-aged children. *Manuscript under revision*

Masi, A., **Esposito, L.**, Cardillo, R. & Caviola, S. (2026). Math anxiety in secondary school children: the role of self-criticism and emotion regulation strategies. *Manuscript in preparation*

AWARDS & GRANTS

Travel Grant Award for the International Society for Intelligence Research (ISIR)

Institute of Mental Chronometry

📅 Warsaw, 2026

Travel Grant Award for the International Society for Intelligence Research (ISIR)

Institute of Mental Chronometry

📅 Zurich, 2024

POSTERS AND PRESENTATIONS (SELECTION)

Esposito L. & Giofrè D. (2024). Sex and group differences in intelligence: A meta-analysis of WISC profiles across typical and atypical development. ISIR 2026 - International Society for Intelligence Research (Warsaw, July 13-16 2026). Poster.

Esposito L. & Giofrè D. (2025). Investigating the Impact of Attitudes and Learning Environment on Math Achievement: Insights from the TIMSS Data. ISSID 2025 - International Society for the Study of Individual Differences (Vienna, July 14-18 2025). Oral presentation.

Esposito L., Toffalini E., & Giofrè D. (2024). Sex Differences in Intelligence on the WISC: A Meta-Analysis on Children with Specific Learning Disabilities. ISIR 2024 - International Society for Intelligence Research (Zurich, July 29-31 2024). Poster.

Esposito L., Toffalini E., & Giofrè D. (2024). Una metanalisi sulle differenze di genere nei profili cognitivi di bambini e ragazzi con ADHD. XX National Congress Giornate di aggiornamento sull'uso degli strumenti in Psicologia Clinica dello Sviluppo (Bologna, March 1-2). Poster.

Esposito, L., Masi, A., Bignetti, R., Caviola, S. (2022). Aspetti dominio specifici e dominio generali in compiti algebrici nei bambini della scuola secondaria. XXX National Congress AIRIPA (Padova, September 23-24). Poster.

METHODOLOGICAL & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical Skills

- Structural Equation Modeling and latent variable modeling (**lavaan**, **semTools**, **sirt**)
- Meta-analyses (**metafor**, **metaSEM**, **emmeans**)
- Multilevel modeling (**lme4**, **lmerTest**)
- Item Response Theory modeling (**mirt**, **eRm**)

Experimental Design & Programming

- Programming experiments in **PsychoPy/Python**
- Basic experience with **Psychtoolbox/MATLAB**
- Behavioral experiment design and implementation

Programming & Software

- Languages: **R** (proficient), Python (intermediate), MATLAB
- Software: **RStudio**, Mplus, JASP, Latex, Excel
- Operating systems: Windows, macOS, Linux

Data Management & Reproducibility

- Reproducible analyses using **RMarkdown/Quarto**
- Version control with **GitHub** and **OSF**
- Full data workflow management: cleaning to preprocessing

COURSES AND TRAININGS

Summer school: "Path Analysis Models for Cross-Sectional and Longitudinal Data"

University "G.d'Annunzio" in Pescara - Associazione Italiana di Psicologia (AIP)

📅 24/06/2024 - 27/06/2024

Course: "Introduction to Meta-Analysis"

Formazione Metodologica (FORME) MERITEA e Dipartimento di Psicologia - Università Cattolica del Sacro Cuore

📅 24/06/2024 - 12/04/2024

Course: "Electrophysiological Signal Analysis at Different Scales of Complexity"

University of Genova

📅 02/12/2023

Course: "Tools for Open Science: Making Your Scientific Research Accessible and Reproducible"

Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization (DPSS) - University of Padova

📅 23/05/2023 - 25/05/2023

Course: "EEGLAB: Basic Analysis of Electroencephalographic Signals"

Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization (DPSS) - University of Padova

📅 21/11/2022 - 25/11/2022

Course: "Introduction to R: Basic Elements and Advanced Applications"

Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization (DPSS) - University of Padova

📅 07/11/2022 - 11/11/2022

Course: "PsychoPy3: Programming an Experiment"

Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization (DPSS) - University of Padova

📅 17/10/2022 - 21/10/2022

Course: "RMarkdown: Reproducible Analyses, Presentations, Reports, and More in a Single Elegant File"

Department of Developmental Psychology and Socialization (DPSS) - University of Padova

📅 13/06/2022 - 17/06/2022

LANGUAGES

Native language: Italian

English: IELTS Certification B2

📅 13/06/2019

Listening: 6.0 Reading: 7.5 Writing: 5.5 Oral: 6.0

CERTIFICATES

Psychologist qualification

University of Genova

📅 26/07/2023